

ColorOS 13: A more streamlined experience

We tested out Oppo's latest ColorOS 13 and here's what we thought

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Oppo recently unveiled its latest ColorOS iteration – ColorOS 13. As the nomenclature suggests, ColorOS 13 is based on Android 13 that runs alongside, under the hood. While it is named ColorOS 13, this is, in actuality, Oppo's tenth major version of its OS. Oppo synced the numbers to match the Android version of the year back when ColorOS 11 launched. Oppo's ColorOS 13 puts its own spin on Android 13, especially in the visual department. While the global version of ColorOS 13 is now live, it will slowly be rolled out to Oppo devices.

ColorOS bears similarities to OxygenOS, and while the idea of unifying both operating systems has been scraped, you can still see some obvious similarities between the two. Since its inception, ColorOS has evolved into becoming quite feature-rich and pretty user-friendly. There are some issues though such as rampant bloatware and ad notifications. With that said, let's get into the meat of the matter. We tested the Beta version of ColorOS 13 for an entire week, and here's what we think about Oppo's latest OS iteration.

Note: We tested a Beta version of ColorOS 13 on the Oppo Find X5 Pro that was loaned to us by Oppo India. The company had no input into the contents of this article.

VISUAL CHANGES

Oppo has brought a visual overhaul to ColorOS 13 and a couple of iterative upgrades over ColorOS 12. It makes sense since Android 13 is also a comparatively small, iterative upgrade to Android 12. ColorOS 13 has adopted a design language dubbed "Aquamorphic Design" which is inspired by water and its motion. This is apparent in the smooth transitions and animations, and the use of more rounded shapes for icons, folders, and widgets – meant to emulate pebbles.

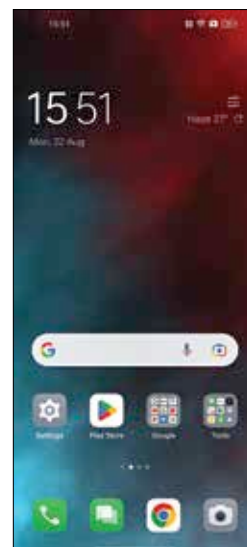
The design isn't too different from the one on ColorOS 12 but there are enough small tweaks to make it feel fresh. If you so wish, you can choose to use Material Style icons in Settings rather than using Oppo's new Aquamorphic style of icons. Additionally, there are tons of customisation options available. You can edit shapes, colour, text size, and more as per your preference. Not just Oppo and Google apps, but third-party app icons can also be styled to a certain extent. Users who are fond of customising their devices

can easily sink hours into customisation. As for colour palettes, you can customise that as you please also. The preset palettes follow the aquatic theme and nature-inspired theme, with shades such as yellows, oranges, and blues being the dominant ones. The shade also changes throughout the day, to emulate sunrise and sunset times. You can change the system colour based on your wallpaper, but the implementation is not solid, and sadly, there is no Material You implementation yet as well.

There is a new Live Wallpaper that

follows the "Aquamorphic Design" template as well. This wallpaper is called "Blossom" wallpaper and it provides an interesting way to measure the time spent on your time. You can set a phone usage target in hours within the wallpapers' settings and as you use your phone, the plant will blossom. But once you exceed your allotted time, the plant will begin to wither. It's a pretty interesting take on alerting users about their screen time.

The user interface has a card layout for easy visual



ColorOS 13 Home Screen